

From hidden gem to the heart of Stanmore

A 12-month plan to make Benjamin's the social heart of The Landsby and a known neighbourhood destination — low capital, residents first, every decision tested against data.

PREPARED FOR

Senior Management, The Landsby · Elysian Residences (Audley Group)

PREPARED BY

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DATE

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101 + 70

Landsby apartments at high occupancy, plus the adjacent private block — an unaddressed doorstep market

~15

total online reviews today, vs hundreds for nearby competitors — an awareness problem, not a quality problem

Closed

on Sundays — the single biggest structural gap, in a catchment where Sunday is the family occasion

~£0

major capital required — access, authority and a modest launch budget, nothing more

90 days

to a measured baseline, live dashboard, trained standards and the first pilots trading

01 — THE SITUATION

A good restaurant that nobody can find

Guests who discover Benjamin's rate it 5.0 and come back. The problems are visibility, under-used capacity and missing systems — exactly what a Restaurant Manager fixes without major investment.

TODAY

No managed Google profile, website, social channels or delivery presence
Open to the public — but barely anyone knows
Closed Sundays; service ends 20:00; events and private dining under-sold
No structured cost, labour or guest data informing decisions

THE OPPORTUNITY

Affluent, older HA7 catchment with strong Jewish and Indian/Gujarati communities — family-occasion diners on our doorstep
A calm, service-led position no local competitor occupies
The restaurant is also Elysian's most visible sales asset for prospective buyers
Post-merger, Benjamin's can become the F&B reference model for 30+ group villages

One identity, three hero offers

"Club-style British and European comfort dining, done properly — *with carefully chosen Indian and Asian specials.*"

1 Weekday resident dining The everyday foundation: familiar, nutrition-aware, never rushed. An extension of home, not an occasional treat.	2 Afternoon tea The signature occasion — suits the room, the demographic, and a daypart we already staff.	3 Sunday family lunch The structural gap, aimed precisely at local family habits. Piloted for 8 weeks against pre-agreed gates.
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Five pillars, one principle: residents first

PILLAR 1 Visibility	Claim and complete the free digital basics (Google profile, listings, photography, social), activate the doorstep (70 adjacent apartments, Sunday lunch, afternoon tea), then earn local standing through clubs, societies and one ticketed event a month. Review target: from ~15 to 100+ at ≥4.5.
PILLAR 2 Operational efficiency	Daypart audit, then hours and rotas reshaped to measured demand. Menu engineering by margin and popularity; portion specs, waste log, supplier reviews. Labour and food cost tracked weekly within agreed bands.
PILLAR 3 Service & food quality	Written service standards for every step of the guest journey — trained, audited, never rushed. Consent-based resident preference records. Photographed plate specs, line checks, quarterly menu refresh shaped by the resident dining committee and nutrition-aware design.
PILLAR 4 Training & team	Daily briefings, cross-training across restaurant, bar and events; accredited development (food safety, allergens, WSET). Career pathways across the enlarged Elysian–Audley group — join to grow, stay to lead.
PILLAR 5 Data-driven decisions	Full value from systems the group already owns — Cubigo, Apicbase, Monika, Square — feeding one tool-agnostic weekly dashboard. Every pilot gets success criteria before launch and a stop/scale decision on evidence.

A concrete first 90 days, then build and grow

DAYS 1–14 Baseline everything. POS tagging live, Google profile claimed, daily briefings begin.	DAYS 15–30 Dashboard v1 live; targets agreed with GM. Photography, social, dining committee, letter to the 70 apartments.	DAYS 31–60 Standards trained. Apicbase fully populated. Menu engineering round 1; demand-based rotas; afternoon tea relaunch.	DAYS 61–90 Sunday pilot launches. First ticketed event. Formal 90-day review against the dashboard.	MONTHS 4–6 Pilots conclude — scale, adjust or stop on the gates. Events cadence and private dining push begin.	MONTHS 7–12 Scale what works. "Landsby at Home" resident delivery. Year-end: a documented playbook for the group.
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Pilots earn their place, or they stop

All figures are stated planning assumptions, replaced with actuals by day 30. The model — not the placeholder numbers — is the commitment.

Sunday lunch — worked break-even

Incremental labour (2 kitchen, 2–3 FOH, ~30–35 hrs)	~£500–600
Energy, consumables, marketing share	~£100–150
Incremental Sunday cost	~£650–750
Gross profit per cover (£30 × ~67% GM)	~£20
Break-even	~33–38 covers

12-month ambition: +25–40% covers and +10% spend per head ≈ £2,000–3,500 additional weekly revenue at validated margins.

PRE-AGREED SUCCESS GATES (WEEKS 5–8 AVG)

- ✓ ≥ 45 covers per Sunday
- ✓ ≥ £28 spend per head
- ✓ Labour ≤ 45% of Sunday revenue during the pilot, with a route to ≤ 35% once established
- ✓ ≥ 90% resident satisfaction — no decline vs weekday baseline
- ✓ ≥ 20% repeat or resident-family bookings by week 8

All gates met → permanent. Covers trending up ≥10% week-on-week → extend four weeks. Otherwise → stop, publish the learning, redeploy. **No pilot becomes permanent by default.**

06 — MEASUREMENT

The scoreboard management sees

MEASURE	12-MONTH TARGET	MEASURE	12-MONTH TARGET
Resident dining frequency	+30% vs month-1 baseline	Online reviews	100+ at ≥ 4.5 rating
Weekly covers	+25–40%	Sunday lunch	Profitable day, or evidenced decision not to
External share of covers	20–25%, capped to protect residents	Guest satisfaction	≥ 90% positive, reviewed weekly
Spend per head	+10% via menu engineering	Team	100% trained to standard; turnover below sector norm

Leading indicators tracked weekly because revenue lags effort: Google profile views and calls, booking-link clicks, review conversion, survey response rate, repeat bookings, private dining enquiries, club/society pipeline.

07 — GUARDRAILS & ASKS

Hard rules, modest requirements

RESIDENT PROTECTION — HARD RULES

1. **Priority booking:** residents book any time; external windows open later and never displace a resident
2. **Protected capacity:** resident tables every service; resident-only periods where demand warrants
3. **External cap per service,** aligned to the 20–25% overall share target
4. **Concierge arrival process** for external guests — security and tone preserved
5. **Communication before change:** every pilot preceded by resident communication and committee consultation

WHAT I NEED FROM MANAGEMENT

1. Reporting access to **Cubigo, Apicbase, Monika and Square** from day one
2. Listings authority (Google, OpenTable, Tripadvisor) and a dining page on the Landsby web presence
3. Modest launch budget — photography, print, signage
4. Sign-off for the 8-week Sunday pilot against the gates in \$05
5. Training budget per head; co-promotion via Elysian channels
6. Weekly GM check-in · monthly P&L · quarterly senior review — the same dashboard at every level

Built on what the group already owns

Cubigo POS & front of house — sales, product mix, resident vs external tagging	Apicbase Back office — recipe costing, allergens, stock and waste tagging	Monika Automated HACCP temperature monitoring — audit-ready by default	Square Payments — reconciled against Cubigo reporting
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Plus a capability the group doesn't have to buy: I bring hands-on AI automation engineering and app-building experience. I can personally build the connective tissue between these systems — automated reporting, demand forecasting for rotas, staff-facing allergen and preference lookups — at no software cost. Built tool-agnostic, so the reporting survives the directors' current systems review; and built to export, so whatever proves its value at Benjamin's can be adapted and reused at any other Elysian–Audley site. The first of these — the weekly one-page dashboard — already exists as a working demonstration on clearly labelled sample data, available to show on request.

Accountable to numbers, not adjectives

Hospitality leadership

Warm, high-touch service of the kind guests already praise — made repeatable through standards and training.

Commercial discipline

Menu engineering, cost control and revenue management applied weekly, fully transparent to the GM and group.

AI automation & app building

An unusual combination for a restaurant manager: I build the internal tools this plan describes — and build them so other sites can adopt them.

Respect for the setting

Residents' home first, a restaurant second, a sales showcase third — the plan is sequenced in exactly that order.

"A genuinely good restaurant, an affluent and under-served catchment, a deserving resident community, and a newly enlarged group looking for operating models that work. Benjamin's can be that model — and within twelve months we will prove it with numbers."

Benjamin's at The Landsby · Merrion Avenue, Stanmore HA7 · Restaurant Manager plan — June 2026

Full plan with sources available on request